

A Day in San Antonio

Many of San Antonio's sights are downtown, within walking distance of each other, including the Alamo, the fashionable River Walk, and the bustling Market Square. South of downtown, the atmospheric La Villita and King William historic districts are fun to stroll around.

MORNING Visit the **Alamo**, where frontier heroes including Jim Bowie and Davy Crockett were besieged for 13 days by the Mexican army in 1836 and gave their lives for Texan independence. Then make your way via the French-Gothic **San Fernando Cathedral** to Market Square and **El Mercado**, the vivid Mexican marketplace filled with colorful merchandise, crafts, jewelry, and lilting mariachi music.

AFTERNOON Drive to the South Side, where four lovely colonial churches lie within the **San Antonio Missions National Historical Park**. On the way back, catch the sunset from the observation deck of the landmark **Tower of the Americas** in Hemisphere Park.

EVENING Stroll along the **River Walk**, where the twinkling lights of the many bars and restaurants make a romantic end to the day.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

San Antonio International Airport is 7 miles (11 km) north of downtown; **shuttles**, a **bus** service, and **taxis** run into the city center. Once there, the downtown can be **walked**, though a **rental car** is useful for exploring farther afield.

WHERE TO STAY

Bonner Garden (inexpensive) is an award-winning B&B in the Monte Vista Historic District. www.bonnnergarden.com

Crockett Hotel (moderate), a historic building, is just steps from the Alamo and has a friendly atmosphere. www.crocketthotel.com

Omni La Mansion del Rio (expensive) is an historic gem offering rustic-style luxury. www.omnihotels.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

317 Alamo Plaza; www.visitsanantonio.com



Right Chunks of prime beef, not ground beef, are used in an authentic chili, with soft beans tempering the fire of the spice

Below An evening river cruise is a perfect way to experience the music, color, and lights of the River Walk

